



File No.: EXP202407580

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Considering the complaint registered on May 8, 2024, with this Agency and the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: A.A.A. (hereinafter, the complainant) exercised the right of Access against CENTRO DE MEDICINA ESTÉTICA MELVAN, S.L. (hereinafter, the complained party) without their request receiving the legally established response. The complainant states that on April 2, 2024, they exercised their right of access before the complained party, requesting a copy of their medical history. They assert that they have not received a response within the one-month period provided for this.

SECOND: In accordance with Article 65.4 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), this complaint was forwarded to the complained party for them to analyze it and inform this Agency within one month of the actions taken to comply with the requirements set forth in data protection regulations.

THIRD: The result of the transfer procedure indicated in the previous Fact did not allow for the understanding that the complainant's claims were satisfied. Consequently, on August 8, 2024, for the purposes provided for in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, the Director of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data agreed to admit the complaint for processing.

The aforementioned agreement granted the complained party a hearing period, so that within ten working days they could present the allegations they deemed appropriate, summarizing the following allegations:

"Through this document, we REAFFIRM everything stated in our document dated August 8, 2024, along with all the documents submitted, given that the situation of the company has not changed."

In which they argued the following:

C/ Jorge Juan, 6
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28001 – Madrid
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2/6

"We cannot resolve this matter, as we have stated, the company is liquidated without activity since it entered voluntary bankruptcy that ended without assets. The place where the services were carried out was a franchise that is also extinguished."

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the Presidency of the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, this organic law, the regulatory provisions issued in its development, and, in so far as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

II

Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Agency for the Protection of Data is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, among them, to enforce the

Regulation and promote awareness among controllers and processors regarding the obligations that pertain to them, as well as to address the complaints submitted by a data subject and investigate, as appropriate, the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In the case that they have appointed a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns them the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, following the procedure provided for in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, prior to the admission of the complaint regarding the exercise of the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, which gives rise to this procedure, it was forwarded to the complained party for them to analyze it, respond to this Agency within one month, and prove that they had provided the complainant with the due response.

The result of that transfer did not allow for the understanding that the complainant's claims were satisfied. Consequently, on August 8, 2024, for the purposes

C/ Jorge Juan, 6

www.aepd.es

28001 – Madrid

sedeagpd.gob.es

3/6

As provided in Articles 64.1 and 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint submitted was admitted for processing. This admission for processing determines the initiation of the present procedure regarding the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, which states:

“When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of April 27, 2016, it will be initiated by an admission agreement, which will be adopted in accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of this organic law.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure will be six months from the date on which the agreement of admission for processing was notified to the complainant. After this period, the interested party may consider their complaint accepted.”

Article 58.2 of the GDPR grants the Spanish Data Protection Agency a series of corrective powers for the purpose of rectifying any infringement of the GDPR, including “ordering the controller or processor to address the requests for the exercise of the rights of the data subject under this Regulation.”

III

Rights of Individuals in Relation to Personal Data Protection

The rights of individuals in relation to personal data protection are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights of access, rectification, deletion, opposition, the right to limit processing, and the right to data portability are contemplated.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, consideration is given to what is expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR.

In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the data subject, which will be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless they can demonstrate that they are unable to identify the data subject, and must state their reasons if they do not intend to address such request. The burden of proof for compliance with the duty to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party lies with the controller.

The communication addressed to the data subject regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

C/ Jorge Juan, 6

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Right of Access

In accordance with Article 15 of the GDPR and Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, “the data subject has the right to obtain from the data controller confirmation as to whether or not personal data concerning them is being processed and, if so, the right of access to the personal data.”

Regarding the right of access to personal data, according to Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, when the exercise of the right refers to a large amount of data, the controller may request the affected party to specify the “data or processing activities to which the request refers.” The right will be considered granted if the controller provides remote access to the data, and the request will be deemed addressed (although the data subject may request information regarding the aspects provided in Article 15 of the GDPR).

The exercise of this right may be considered repetitive if it is exercised more than once within a six-month period, unless there is a legitimate reason for doing so. On the other hand, the request will be considered excessive when the affected party chooses a means other than that offered which incurs a disproportionate cost, which must be borne by the affected party.

Like the other rights of the data subject, the right of access is a personal right. It allows the citizen to obtain information about the processing of their data, the possibility of obtaining a copy of the personal data concerning them that is being processed, as well as information, in particular, about the purposes of the processing, the categories of personal data concerned, the recipients or categories of recipients to whom the data may be communicated, the expected retention period or criteria for retention, the possibility of exercising other rights, the right to lodge a complaint with the supervisory authority, the information available about the source of the data (if it has not been obtained directly from the data subject), the existence of automated decisions, including profiling, and information about transfers of personal data to a third country or to an international organization. The possibility of obtaining a copy of the personal data being processed shall not adversely affect the rights and freedoms of others.

V

Conclusion

During the processing of this procedure, the entity being complained against has responded to this Agency, highlighting the situation of insolvency in which it finds itself and the impossibility of addressing the request made by the complainant, solely in light of that situation.

Consequently, it does not demonstrate that it has addressed the request made by the complainant, nor that it has informed them of the reasons for its inaction and the possibility of filing a complaint with a supervisory authority and exercising legal actions.

C/ Jorge Juan, 6

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28001 – Madrid

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referring you in any case to the mandatory response to your request. The respondent is reminded that being in a state of insolvency does not exempt it from fulfilling its obligations regarding data protection, among which is the proper preservation and custody of medical records.

Thus, it cannot be accepted that the response to be given can be manifested as a mere administrative procedure, such as the submission of allegations in the present procedure, initiated precisely for not properly addressing the request in question, but rather a response must be given to the respondent itself.

The aforementioned regulations do not allow the request to be overlooked as if it had not been raised, leaving it without the response that the responsible parties must issue, even in the event that there are no data in the files or even in those cases where the requirements are not met, in which case the recipient of such request is also obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, if

applicable, to deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the responsible party to provide an express response in any case, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

Given that a copy of the necessary communication that must be directed to the claimant informing them about the decision made regarding the exercise of rights request is not attached, it is appropriate to uphold the complaint that originated the present procedure.

In view of the cited provisions and other generally applicable regulations, the Presidency of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD the complaint filed by A.A.A. considering that the provisions of Article 15 of the GDPR have been infringed and to urge CENTRO DE MEDICINA ESTÉTICA MELVAN, S.L. with NIF B55755698, to send to the claimant, within ten working days following the notification of this resolution, a certification addressing the requested right or denying it with justification indicating the reasons why the request cannot be attended to, in accordance with the provisions established in the body of this resolution. The actions taken as a result of this Resolution must be communicated to this Agency within the same period. Non-compliance with this resolution could result in the commission of an infringement of Article 83.6 of the GDPR, classified as very serious for the purposes of prescription in Article 72.1.m) of the LOPDGDD, which will be sanctioned in accordance with Article 58.2 of the GDPR.

SECOND: NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to CENTRO DE MEDICINA ESTÉTICA MELVAN, S.L. In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

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6/6

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure in accordance with Article 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested parties may optionally file a motion for reconsideration before the Presidency of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file a contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and in section 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law. 1381-090823

Olga Pérez Sanjuán

The Deputy Director General of Data Inspection, in accordance with Article 48.2 LOPDGDD, due to vacancy of the Presidency and Deputy Presidency

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